

KYLE GAARDER

Community Events Leader | Marketing & Growth | Programming

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SUMMARY

Community event designer and growth operator. Built a portfolio of 48+ events, 4 masterminds, and 6 structured programs from scratch. I design programming that drives member satisfaction and acquisition in shared spaces. My background combines event production with growth marketing - building demand pipelines and converting attendees into long-term members.

EXPERIENCE

Founder, Product & Operations

Revillage Coliving

- 📅 08/2022 - 07/2024 📍 Austin, TX
- Launched an 8-bedroom coliving property in 2 weeks, reaching
 - 100% occupancy before lease start
 - Designed and produced 48 weekly dinners, 4 mastermind cohorts, and 6 work-trade programs
 - Built event-driven growth engine sustaining 94% occupancy
 - retention for 19 consecutive months
 - Created member onboarding and engagement loops driving satisfaction and long-term retention
 - Executed A/B testing on pricing and event models, generating 48% annual revenue lift

- Directed full-cycle operations, improving efficiency 212% YoY
- across events and facility ops

- Facilitated smooth acquisition transition while maintaining programming continuity

Co-Founder, Strategy & Operations

Van Village

- 📅 01/2021 - 08/2022 📍 Portland, OR
- Built demand pipeline of 3,140 subscribers through grassroots marketing and outreach
 - Conducted 48 customer interviews to understand community preferences and event demand
 - Explored partnerships across 5 states and personally secured an investor-backed pilot program
 - Led marketing and community growth across strategy, ops, and brand in startup environment

Co-Founder, Operations & Growth

Lake Barcroft Boats

- 📅 01/2011 - 01/2016 📍 Falls Church, VA
- Built a niche service business from zero to 140+ clients
 - Achieved 82% customer retention through relationship-driven service
 - Generated 46% year-over-year revenue growth by improving pricing, operations, and service offerings
 - Personally closed 30-40 new clients per summer through direct outreach and referrals
 - Managed scheduling, pricing, contractors, and customer relationships across 230+ completed service contracts

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- 💎

48+ Events from Scratch
Designed and produced 48 dinners, 4 masterminds, and 6 programs driving community growth
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3,140-Sub Growth Pipeline
Built early demand pipeline of 3,140 subscribers through grassroots marketing and outreach
- 💎

94% Retention via Events
Event-driven community design sustained 94% occupancy for 19 consecutive months
- 💎

Investor Pilot Secured
Sourced and secured an investor-backed pilot for a new community concept across 5 states
- 💎

48% Revenue Growth
A/B tested pricing and engagement models driving 48% annual revenue increase

SKILLS

- Event Design & Production
- Community Marketing
- Growth & Demand Generation
- Brand Programming
- Member Acquisition Retention
- Stakeholder Management Vendors
- Partnerships Market Creation

EDUCATION

- Bachelors in Science, Biology**
Virginia Tech

📅 08/2010 - 05/2014
📍 Virginia, USA
 - Minors in Psychology, International Studies, Spanish

GPA
3.5 / 4.0